Consent to Participate in Research

IRB-FY2025-169

Title of Study: Understanding the Impact of Spirituality on Technological Imagination and Design for Sustainability

Principal Investigator: Sarah Cooney
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KEY INFORMATION

Purpose: This study is being done to understand how people's religious/spiritual values impact how they think about sustainability and how they imagine using technology to solve sustainability challenges in their communities.

Procedures: If you choose to participate, you will participate in a 90-minute workshop where you will learn about sustainability and then work in a small group to design a hypothetical technology to solve sustainability challenges. At the beginning of the workshop you will fill out a short survey with questions about your demographics, sustainability attitudes, and religious / spiritual practices.

Duration: You will spend about 90 minutes in the study.

Risks: There may be some risks or discomforts, such as discussing potentially sensitive topics such as climate change and religious beliefs..

Benefits: You may or may not get a direct benefit. The main benefit could be helping to inform the design of future technologies to solve sustainability challenges.

Compensation: You could be paid up to $20 for participating in this study.

Participation: Joining is your choice. If you join, you are consenting to the PI using photos and lecture capture as data collection methods. You can stop at any time without penalty.

Please read the whole document carefully. Ask any questions you have before you decide.

This study has been reviewed and approved by the Villanova University Institutional Review Board (IRB). You can contact the IRB office at irb@villanova.edu if you have any questions or concerns.

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Study Summary

You are invited to join a research study conducted by Villanova University's Department of Computing Sciences. This study will involve a 90-minute workshop which will include learning about sustainability and imagining technology to solve sustainability challenges as well as a brief demographic survey. You may choose not to participate. There are no penalties or loss of benefits if you decline.

Why is this study being done?

The purpose of this study is to better understand how framing sustainability in terms of religious/spiritual values might impact how people design and use technology to tackle sustainability challenges in their communities.

Who is being asked to participate?

You will be one of approximately 45 participants in this study.

You are being asked to participate because you are a member of the Villanova community and are 18+ years of age. You will not be eligible to participate if any of the following apply:

- You are not a member of the Villanova community
- You are under the age of 18.

What will I be asked to do?

If you choose to participate, you will participate in a 90-minute workshop facilitated by the PI or a member of the research team. The PI will be present at all workshops. In the workshop, you will do the following:

- Fill out a short demographic survey.
- Be introduced to the workshop facilitator and other members of the research team.
- Participate in a short ice breaker to get to know other participants.
- Be given a short presentation about sustainability and an introduction to four pathways or key areas for making sustainable choices– transportation, shelter/energy, food/water, and consumer purchases.
- Work in a small group (~3-4 participants) to imagine a technological solution to help members of the Villanova community tackle a sustainability challenge by making a poster to illustrate the imagine solution.
- Share your group's imagined solution with whole group (~12-15 participants) and discuss solutions proposed by other groups.

How much time will the study take?

The study will take about 90 minutes.

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Will this study help me?
You may or may not get any direct benefit from being in this study. You may benefit by reflecting on your habits in light of sustainability concerns. The information we learn may help others in the future by guiding the design of new technologies to tackle climate challenges.

Are there risks?
The risks from taking part in this study are minimal, meaning they are no greater than the risks you would normally have in daily life or during routine medical or psychological tests. The workshop and intake survey will touch on topics--religion and sustainability--that could be sensitive or uncomfortable for some people to discuss. You will have the option to skip any intake questions that make you uncomfortable.

Will I be paid?
You will receive up to $20 in the form of a digital payment via Zelle after you complete the study. You should get your payment within one week after completing the workshop. If you do not finish the whole workshop, you will be paid according to the percentage you completed. Payment for research may be considered income. Ask a tax professional if you have questions.

How will my information be protected?
We will do everything we can to protect your privacy and keep your information confidential. However, we cannot promise complete anonymity.

We will collect some personal information about you, like your name, Villanova affiliation, and email. Identifying information will be used for compensation purposes only. This information will be kept on Villanova's secure cloud.

We will also retain the posters you make in the small group portion of the workshop. We may retain notes you take during the workshop if you do not want to keep them, or take photos of them. The posters will be stored securely in the PI's office.

Research assistants will endeavor to take only photos that are not identifiable such as close ups or photos of artifacts produced in the workshops. Only trained research team members will have access to photos, and no photos with identifiable individuals will be used in any publications or other public materials.

Videos of the workshops will be taken via lecture capture technology and will be securely stored in the Villanova cloud via Mediasite. The videos will be transcribed and used in the qualitative analysis, and will not be shared outside of the trained members of the research team.

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We will remove your name and any identifying information from your data whenever possible and use a study identification code (like 101) instead. The list that links your name to the code will be kept on a password-protected computer by the principal investigator.

Data will be stored on Villanova's secure server and only the research team will be able to see it. All data will be kept indefinitely and may be used in future related studies.

If we share results of this study in a presentation or publication, your name will not be included.

Your privacy will be maintained to the fullest extent permitted by law. Authorized individuals, including IRB representatives, government regulators, and research sponsors may inspect your records to ensure compliance with research standards.

Will my data be used in the future?
The information you give in this study may be used for other research later without additional consent. Before that happens, the new study will be reviewed and approved by the Institutional Review Board (IRB) to make sure the research is going to be done responsibly and ethically. Your personal details, like your name or contact information, will be removed or replaced with a code to protect your identity. Only data that does not identify you will be shared with other researchers or used in future studies. You will not be contacted about any future research that uses your data.

Do I have to join this study?
Participation is completely voluntary. If you join, you can stop at any time.

If you leave the study early, we will keep the data we have already collected.

The researchers may remove you from the study if you do not follow the study steps or if it is not safe for you to continue.

Your choice will not affect your relationship with Villanova now or later.

What if I have questions or problems?
You can ask questions anytime. If you have any questions about the study, please contact the Principal Investigator, Sarah Cooney at sarah.cooney@villanova.edu.

If you have questions about your rights as a participant or concerns about the study, you may contact the Villanova University Institutional Review Board (IRB) at irb@villanova.edu or 610-519-4228.

You may also call the Ethics Point hotline, a third-party unaffiliated with Villanova, toll-free at 855-236-1443 if you do not want to speak to the researcher or IRB.

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Resources for Participants

Villanova offers resources to help you during and after the study. You can find both of these documents on the Villanova IRB website under "Participating in a Research Study."

Villanova Research Participant Resources: This guide explains what to do if you have questions or concerns about the study. It lists contact information for the IRB and other support services, including mental health resources.

Participant Bill of Rights: This document explains your rights as a research participant. It includes your right to clear information about the study, your right to ask questions, your right to privacy, and your right to stop participating at any time without penalty.

Signature Page

Adult Research Participant

By signing below, you agree to take part in this research study. You confirm that you are 18 years or older.

Participants: I agree to join this study and allow my information to be used and shared as explained in this form. My questions have been answered. I will get a copy of this signed form.

_____

Research Participant's Printed Name

_____ _____

Research Participant's Signature Date

Person Obtaining Consent: I confirm that the research study was thoroughly explained to the participant. I reviewed the consent form with the participant and answered all questions. The participant appeared to understand the information and agreed voluntarily to participate.

_____

Person Obtaining Consent Printed Name

_____ _____

Person Obtaining Consent Signature Date

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